



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय
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— Tantravārttika, (ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय)

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The heart of this verse from the Tantravārttika speaks to a fundamental distinction in how we approach actions, separating those with visible results from those rooted in unseen benefits. It tells us that in actions where the purpose is clear and readily observable – 'dr̥ṣṭārtheṣu' – there is equality regardless of background or label ('ārya' or 'mleccha'). However, when it comes to actions whose fruits are not immediately apparent, actions performed for unseen or spiritual purposes – 'adr̥ṣṭārtheṣu' – those with a deeper understanding and connection, the 'āryas,' are considered to have a greater advantage.

Think of it this way: building a house is a 'dr̥ṣṭārtha' action. Anyone, regardless of their spiritual standing, can learn the skills and techniques to construct a dwelling. The result is tangible and measurable. The quality of the house depends on skill and materials, not on the builder's spiritual merit. But consider the practice of meditation, a 'adr̥ṣṭārtha' action. The immediate effects might be subtle, but the long-term benefits, the inner peace and clarity, are profound. The verse suggests that those who have cultivated inner purity and understanding, the 'āryas' in this context, will derive greater benefit from such practices.

In modern life, we can see this principle at play in many areas. Learning a new software program is a 'dr̥ṣṭārtha' activity; anyone can master it with practice. But cultivating compassion and empathy, essential for meaningful relationships, falls into the realm of 'adr̥ṣṭārtha.' Those who have consciously worked on their inner selves, who have striven for ethical living, will naturally find it easier to connect with others on a deeper level. Your own efforts to cultivate kindness and understanding will undoubtedly bear fruit, even if you don't always see the immediate results. The verse encourages you to approach both types of actions with awareness, recognizing the different factors that contribute to their success.

This understanding encourages us to value both practical skills and inner development. It's a call to recognize that while competence is essential in the material world, cultivating inner qualities is vital for spiritual growth and lasting happiness. It reminds us that some things require more than just technical proficiency; they require a sincere heart and a dedicated spirit.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you consciously integrate the understanding of 'dr̥ṣṭārtha' and 'adr̥ṣṭārtha' into your daily choices to create a more balanced and meaningful life?